October 2026 safety report

What happened. Where it happened. What changed. Built from every news report Deckwatch captured in October, grouped into distinct incidents.

192	41	191+	56	537
distinct incidents	of 47 counties affected	deaths reported	incidents reported by 2+ outlets	news articles reviewed

Reviewed by hand Data as of 4 Nov, 09:58 EAT

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01 · THE MONTH IN SAFETY

Two bus disasters on the Mombasa road, and Kenya's first Ebola death

Deckwatch captured **192 distinct incidents in 41 counties**, with at least **191 deaths** reported. Crime & security incidents caused the most deaths (79). The deadliest hotspot was Nairobi–Mombasa highway, Makueni stretch, with **4 incidents and 41 deaths**. Nairobi recorded the most incidents captured by Deckwatch. The most-reported story was "Seventeen Catholic pilgrims bound for Subukia killed in multi-vehicle crash at Salama", covered 36 times by 7 outlets.

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02 · WHAT HAPPENED

Crime and security made up over four in ten incidents and caused the most deaths. Road crashes killed 68 people, 39 of them in two crashes in Makueni.

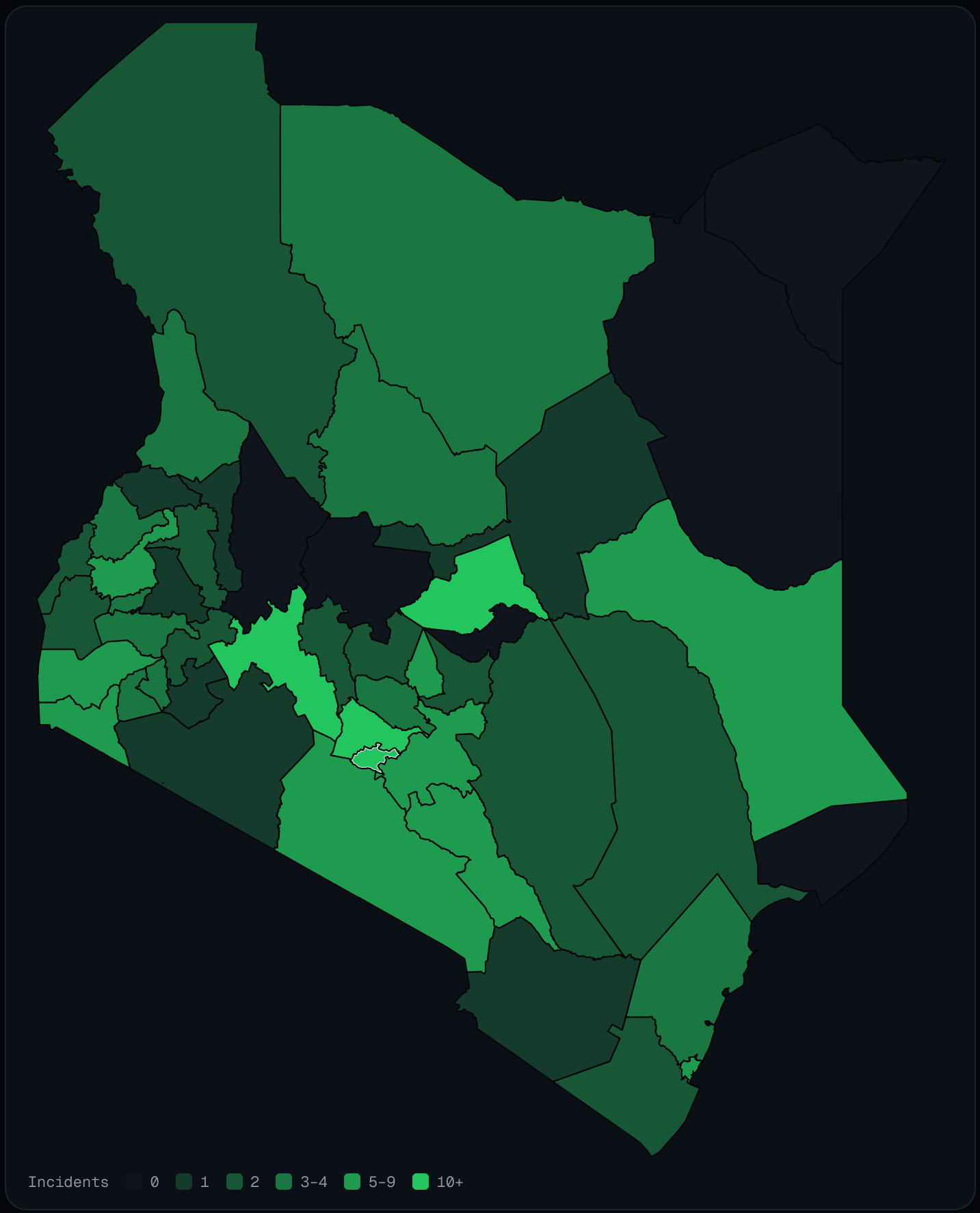


Death figures use the lowest number reported across sources. Reports that said only “several feared dead” count as zero, so these are floors.

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03 · WHERE IT HAPPENED

Nairobi recorded the most incidents captured by Deckwatch. Makueni recorded the most deaths.


Incidents
0
1
2
3-4
5-9
10+

COUNTY	INCIDENTS	DEATHS	MAIN CONCERN
047 Nairobi	35	16	Crime & security
012 Meru	12	11	Crime & security
032 Nakuru	10	12	Road & transport
022 Kiambu	10	9	Crime & security
020 Kirinyaga	9	6	Missing persons
016 Machakos	9	6	Crime & security
034 Kajiado	7	5	Crime & security
043 Homa Bay	6	7	Crime & security
037 Kakamega	6	4	Crime & security
001 Mombasa	6	1	Fire & explosions
017 Makueni	5	40	Road & transport
007 Garissa	5	7	Crime & security

Top 12 of 41 counties shown. Select a county on the map or in the table to open its brief. **No incidents were captured in 6 counties**: Baringo, Laikipia, Lamu, Mandera, Tharaka-Nithi, Wajir. That may reflect thin news coverage rather than a quiet month.

04 · EMERGING HOTSPOTS

6 places and patterns with repeated incidents

Counties are too coarse to plan a journey with. These are the corridors, towns and patterns where Deckwatch captured several separate incidents this month.

Nairobi–Mombasa highway, Makueni stretch

4 incidents · 41 deaths · 2 counties

Nakuru–Eldoret highway

4 incidents · 6 deaths · 1 county

The Sachangwan tanker explosion that closed the road on 6 October, a crash that injured 17

The Salama pilgrims' crash on 3 October, a second pile-up at Salama the next day, and the Mtito Andei bus–lorry collision on 25 October. The two worst crashes of the year happened 70 km apart on the same road, and together killed 39 people.

- 3 Oct — Seventeen Catholic pilgrims bound for Subukia killed in multi-vehicle crash at Salama
- 4 Oct — Second multi-vehicle crash near Salama, hours after the pilgrims' crash; residents demand the road be expanded
- 25 Oct — Twenty-two killed as bus and lorry collide head-on near Mtito Andei
- 26 Oct — Military truck overturns on Mombasa–Nairobi highway, killing two and injuring five

mourners, a multi-vehicle crash at Salgaa, and six deaths in a truck–matatu–car collision on the last day of the month.

- 6 Oct — Fuel tanker explodes at Sachangwan, closing the Nakuru–Eldoret highway; Red Cross reports two casualties
- 18 Oct — Seventeen injured as vehicle carrying mourners from Kisumu crashes on Nakuru–Eldoret highway
- 23 Oct — Multi-vehicle crash at Salgaa disrupts traffic on Nakuru–Eldoret highway
- 31 Oct — Six killed as truck, matatu and car collide on Nakuru–Eldoret highway

Gold mines and quarries

5	12	3
incidents	deaths	counties

Five collapses in West Pokot, Migori and Meru killed 12 people, all in small-scale gold mining or quarrying. Two West Pokot collapses four days apart account for nine of the deaths.

- 3 Oct — At least five dead, three rescued as gold mine collapses in West Pokot
- 7 Oct — Tanzanian miner dies as shaft collapses in Migori
- 7 Oct — Four miners die in another gold mine collapse in West Pokot
- 21 Oct — Quarry collapses at Mutonga, killing one and trapping several workers
- 31 Oct — Grade 10 pupil dies in quarry accident a day after school closed

Northern frontier

11	14	5
incidents	deaths	counties

An al-Shabaab bomb on the Dadaab road, bandit raids in Turkana, Marsabit, Samburu and Isiolo, Ethiopian fighting spilling into Moyale, and two children killed by old ordnance in Garissa. Police officers and reservists were among the dead.

- 6 Oct — Protesters storm the Interior CS's office demanding answers over the Samburu shootings
- 9 Oct — Two police officers killed in al-Shabaab roadside bomb on Saretho–Dadaab road
- 17 Oct — 65-year-old man shot dead by bandits
- 22 Oct — Ethiopian clashes spill into Moyale: stray bullets hit a woman and an officer as hundreds flee into Kenya
- 23 Oct — Suspected bandits attack herders, killing one
- 24 Oct — Woman shot dead as raiders steal 61 goats and sheep
- 25 Oct — Two siblings killed by an unexploded ordnance blast

28 Oct Suspected Ethiopian raiders attack Kibish: herders shot dead, a police reservist missing

29 Oct Police reservist shot dead in attack at Loiyangalani

30 Oct Two killed, three injured as armed bandits raid a village

31 Oct Two killed and a police reservist injured in shooting

Homa Bay

4 incidents | 5 deaths | 1 county

A police operation against town gangs, which made dozens of arrests and set off protests when an alleged gang leader was held, along with fatal clashes and drownings among Lake Victoria fishermen.

8 Oct Two fishermen killed, three injured in beach clash

9 Oct Arrest of alleged gang leader Abdi Sebo sparks protests in Homa Bay

12 Oct Police operation to restore order in Homa Bay town: 19 more suspects arrested

17 Oct Three fishermen die in separate incidents on Lake Victoria

Kirinyaga

9 incidents | 6 deaths | 1 county

A pregnant woman who died after allegedly being pushed from a police car, a petrol attendant set alight, the Kagio market fire, a hippo attack, and two missing men later found dead in a river and a dung pit. A university student missing at Thiba Falls had not been found by month's end.

2 Oct Fire razes businesses in Kagio; traders count millions in losses

3 Oct Pregnant woman dies after allegedly being pushed out of a moving police car; DCI opens murder probe

11 Oct Mother and daughter hospitalised after hippo attack

15 Oct Woman killed in motorcycle accident at Makutano flyover

16 Oct Woman, 38, found stabbed to death

19 Oct Missing man found dead in River Nyamindi after eight-day search

20 Oct 19-year-old petrol attendant dies after catching fire while serving a customer

20 Oct Residents search through the night for a university student missing at Thiba Falls

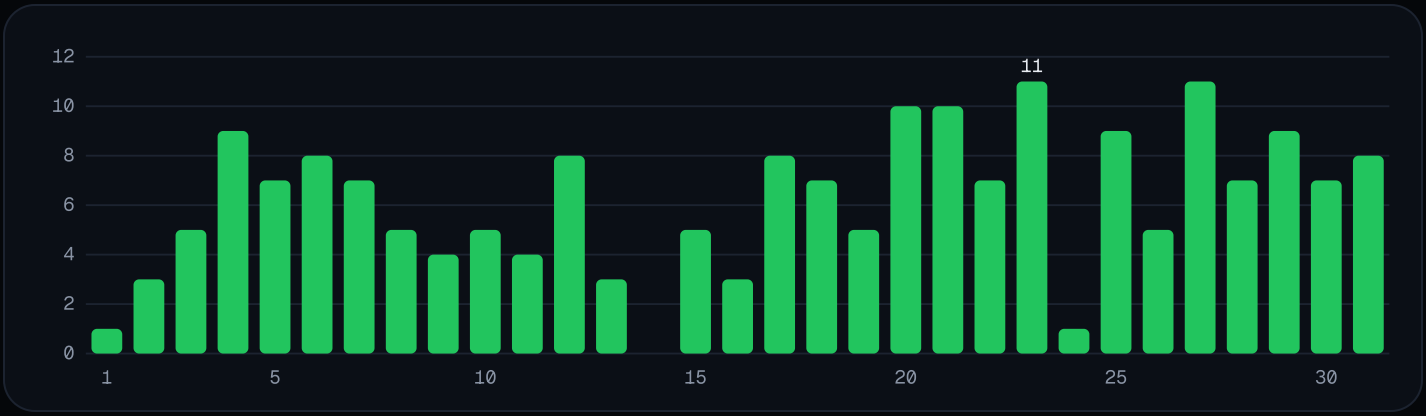
27 Oct Body of man missing for a week found in a cattle dung pit

05 · WHAT CHANGED

Compared with September 2026

Deckwatch captured **192 incidents** this month against 105 in September 2026 (+83%). These are changes in **reported** incidents: more coverage, or a new outlet, can move them as much as events on the ground.

CATEGORY	SEP	OCT	CHANGE
Crime & security	50	83	↑ 66%
Road & transport	19	27	↑ 42%
Fire & explosions	6	19	↑ 217%
Protests & unrest	9	18	↑ 100%
Missing persons	10	15	↑ 50%
Building & mine collapses	5	9	↑ 80%
Flooding & weather	2	9	↑ 350%
Wildlife	3	8	↑ 167%
Animal & public health	1	4	↑ 300%



1-7 OCT

40 incidents · 5.7/day

50 deaths

8-14 OCT

29 incidents · 4.1/day

21 deaths

Seventeen Catholic pilgrims bound for Subukia killed in multi-vehicle crash at Salama · At least five dead, three rescued as gold mine collapses in West Pokot · Four miners die in another gold mine collapse in West Pokot

Lorry rams into other vehicles on Meru–Nkubu road, killing at least four and injuring 16 · Two fishermen killed, three injured in beach clash · Two police officers killed in al-Shabaab roadside bomb on Saretho–Dadaab road

15-21 OCT

48 incidents · 6.9/day

34 deaths

Three fishermen die in separate incidents on Lake Victoria · Elderly couple killed in overnight attack · Two drivers die in head-on crash on Elburgon–Njoro road

22-28 OCT

51 incidents · 7.3/day

59 deaths

Twenty-two killed as bus and lorry collide head-on near Mtito Andei · Three children found dead in a dam in Gatanga; family suspects foul play · Elephants kill two people, a 17-year-old herder in Kilifi and one in Taita Taveta

29-31 OCT · 3 DAYS

24 incidents · 8.0/day

27 deaths

Six killed as truck, matatu and car collide on Nakuru–Eldoret highway · Three killed as vehicle catches fire near Raila Odinga Stadium · Two men shot dead along Isibania–Migori road

06 · THE INCIDENTS THAT DEFINED OCTOBER

8 incidents, chosen for their toll, their reach and how widely they were reported

3 Oct Makueni · 017 Road & transport

Seventeen Catholic pilgrims bound for Subukia killed in multi-vehicle crash at Salama

17 deaths reported | 7 outlets | 36 articles | Conflicting reports

Why it matters. The month opened with the deadliest crash Deckwatch had yet recorded, on the National Prayer Day pilgrimage. NTSA sent a crash team and the Transport CS ordered a probe into the bus's compliance. A church memorial named 16 pilgrims; every other report gives 17.

Citizen Digital Tuko News People Daily Nairobi News +33 more

3 Oct West Pokot · 024 Building & mine collapses

At least five dead, three rescued as gold mine collapses in West Pokot

5 deaths reported | Single outlet | 1 article

Why it matters. The deadliest of five mine and quarry collapses in October, all in small-scale gold mining or quarrying, which led the government to ban gold mining at Lomeguro.

Nairobi News

6 Oct Nairobi · 047 Animal & public health

Kenya confirms its first Ebola death; cases rise to eight by 19 October

1 death reported | 5 outlets | 9 articles | Conflicting reports

Why it matters. Kenya's first Ebola cases, traced to a patient treated in DR Congo. The ministry declared the Bundibugyo strain a formidable epidemic disease and reports 97% contact tracing; leaders in western Kenya warn of cross-border spread. The Health CS first said there was no outbreak, only an imported case; seven days later cases had risen to seven.

Nairobi News People Daily Citizen Digital Citizen Digital +5 more

9 Oct Garissa · 007 Crime & security

Two police officers killed in al-Shabaab roadside bomb on Saretho–Dadaab road

2 deaths reported | 2 outlets | 1 article

Why it matters. The month's only confirmed terror attack, on the road to the Dadaab refugee camps. It came while Lamu leaders warned that young people are going missing into a recruitment network.

Nairobi News People Daily

20 Oct Nairobi · 047 Protests & unrest

Fuel price protests in Nairobi CBD; Citizen TV journalist assaulted and arrested

6 outlets | 7 articles

Why it matters. Protests over EPRA's fuel price rise, with a journalist arrested while covering them. IPOA opened a probe, and activists have set a date to march on State House.

K24 Citizen Digital Ebru TV Citizen Digital +10 more

22 Oct Murang'a · 021 Crime & security

Three children found dead in a dam in Gatanga; family suspects foul play

3 deaths reported | Single outlet | 1 article

Why it matters. The deadliest single crime-related incident of the month outside the highways. Police had not said how the children died by month's end.

Citizen Digital

23 Oct Nairobi · 047 Building & mine collapses

Building under construction collapses in Eastleigh, trapping workers; rescue runs for over a week

1 death reported | 16 outlets | 4 articles | Open | Conflicting reports

Why it matters. The month's longest-running emergency, with 140-plus articles. The DPP says City Hall never filed an inquiry, police are pursuing the owner and contractor, and residents elsewhere have begun protesting new buildings. Counts of the missing ranged from seven to 31; one body was recovered by 30 October and a second after the month ended.

Capital FM News Kenyans.co.ke Citizen Digital Citizen Digital +200 more

25 Oct Makueni · 017 Road & transport

Twenty-two killed as bus and lorry collide head-on near Mtito Andei

22 deaths reported | 11 outlets | 6 articles | Conflicting reports

Why it matters. The deadliest single incident Deckwatch has captured, three weeks after Salama on the same highway. NTSA blamed improper overtaking, and reports say the driver was too tired for the return trip. The toll was first given as 22; later reports say 24.

Capital FM News Tuko News Nation Africa Nairobi News +28 more

07 · YOUR COUNTY

Pick a county to see its month

COUNTY Nairobi (35)

COUNTY 047 · RANK 1 OF 41 BY INCIDENTS

Nairobi, October

35
incidents captured

16
deaths reported

13 / 8
Crime & security / Protests & unrest

29 Oct
busiest day (5 incidents)

2
missing-person cases still open

2 Oct	Protest at Standard Group offices on Mombasa Road; the media house cites threats to press freedom	Protests & unrest
4 Oct	Youths storm Buruburu church over viral bullying video	Protests & unrest
4 Oct	Man jumps from moving matatu to chase phone thief on Nairobi highway	Crime & security
5 Oct	77-year-old security guard found dead in Lang'ata	Crime & security · 1 dead
6 Oct	Activists march through Nairobi CBD, disrupting traffic	Protests & unrest
6 Oct	Kenya confirms its first Ebola death; cases rise to eight by 19 October	Animal & public health · 1 dead
6 Oct	Lorry overturns near China Square on Thika Road, causing heavy traffic	Road & transport
7 Oct	Burglars break into South C hardware through the roof and steal a gun	Crime & security
8 Oct	Woman, 56, found stabbed to death in Kayole	Crime & security · 1 dead
8 Oct	Bus driver and conductor detained after passenger is drugged in Utawala	Crime & security
11 Oct	Fatal shooting of Kenyan-French national, recorded as suicide, now under investigation	Crime & security · 1 dead
16 Oct	Teenager stabbed to death in Eastleigh	Crime & security · 1 dead
17 Oct	Building that housed Club Avenida collapses during demolition, injuring four	Building & mine collapses
17 Oct	Fire breaks out in Nairobi National Park	Fire & explosions
18 Oct	Woman allegedly suffocated to death by boyfriend	Crime & security · 1 dead

19 Oct	3-year-old girl burnt to death in plot fire	Fire & explosions · 1 dead
20 Oct	Water bowser set ablaze after hitting a pedestrian; 28 arrested	Road & transport
20 Oct	Fuel price protests in Nairobi CBD; Citizen TV journalist assaulted and arrested	Protests & unrest
20 Oct	Gang member shot after attacking police officers in Huruma	Crime & security
21 Oct	Public health officers stage protests in Nairobi, threatening to storm government offices	Protests & unrest
21 Oct	Robbery caught on viral video in Parklands; suspect arrested	Crime & security
21 Oct	University of Nairobi students block Waiyaki Way over the lecturers' strike (21 and 27 October)	Protests & unrest
23 Oct	Armed men abduct a man on Dennis Pritt Road	Missing persons
23 Oct	Building under construction collapses in Eastleigh, trapping workers; rescue runs for over a week	Building & mine collapses · 1 dead
23 Oct	Body of a young girl recovered from Ngong River in Embakasi	Flooding & weather · 1 dead
27 Oct	Armed gang holds Chinese nationals hostage in raid on Kilimani construction site	Crime & security
27 Oct	Makadara church faithful protest, demanding the bishop step down	Protests & unrest
29 Oct	Suspected robber shot dead by police in Kariobangi	Crime & security · 1 dead
29 Oct	Deputy President's communications official robbed of Sh3.7 million in equipment	Crime & security
29 Oct	Car hits pedestrians on Ngong Road, killing two and injuring three	Road & transport · 2 dead
29 Oct	Three killed as vehicle catches fire near Raila Odinga Stadium	Fire & explosions · 3 dead
29 Oct	Nairobi traders block streets protesting evictions	Protests & unrest
30 Oct	Conductor killed as Kayole matatu crashes on Kangundo Road	Road & transport · 1 dead
30 Oct	Several injured as 33-seater matatu overturns	Road & transport
31 Oct	Saturday rain floods Parklands roads, raising questions about Nairobi's preparations	Flooding & weather

08 · WHAT WE KNOW AND WHAT WE DON'T

How confident we are in these numbers

What we know

- **56 of 192 incidents** were reported by two or more independent outlets.
- Every incident links back to at least one published article. You can check each one in the full log below.
- **291 articles** described these 192 incidents, which is why Deckwatch counts incidents rather than articles.
- The automatic classifier put an article in the right category **92%**of the time, measured against this report's consolidation.

What remains unclear

- **454 of 537 articles** still carry an "unconfirmed" status in Deckwatch's automatic scoring. Automatic corroboration merged only 90 duplicates this month.
- The automatic county was wrong for about **15%** of incident articles. This report corrects them; the live map does not yet.
- **Reports conflicted** on key facts in 8 incidents, including seventeen catholic pilgrims bound for subukia killed in multi-vehicle crash at salama; kenya confirms its first ebola death; fuel tanker explodes at sachangwan.
- **10 missing-person cases** had no reported resolution by the end of the month.
- Deckwatch reads 17 news outlets, most of them Nairobi-based, and has no citizen reports yet. Remote counties are likely under-counted, and 6 counties had no captured incidents at all.

09 · WHAT TO WATCH IN NOVEMBER

Based on official warnings and on incidents still unfolding

None of this is a prediction. Each item comes from warnings or ongoing events already reported.

> **Short rains and El Niño**

Tana River floods displaced 302 households in the last days of October, and rain has already flooded Parklands and Mombasa. A girl was swept away in Kajiado and a toddler drowned in a pit in Taveta. Rising Lake Nakuru has displaced 200 families.

DO If you live near the Tana, a river or a drainage channel, know your nearest high ground now. Check the Deckwatch map and Kenya Meteorological Department alerts before travelling in heavy rain, and never cross flowing water.

Ebola

Kenya had eight confirmed cases and one death by 19 October, all linked to a patient treated in DR Congo. The Health Ministry reports 97% contact tracing and has declared the Bundibugyo strain a formidable epidemic disease. Leaders in western Kenya are warning about cross-border movement.

DO Follow Ministry of Health guidance only. Anyone with fever and bleeding after contact with a sick traveller should call the Ministry of Health hotline before going to a crowded facility.

The Mombasa road through Makueni

The Salama and Mtito Andei crashes killed 39 people in three weeks. NTSA blamed improper overtaking and driver fatigue on long return trips. Enforcement operations started after Salama.

DO Avoid night travel on the Nairobi–Mombasa highway where you can, and refuse to board a bus whose driver has just completed the outbound trip. Report dangerous PSV driving to NTSA.

Building safety after Eastleigh

The Eastleigh rescue was still running when the month ended, and a CBD building collapsed during demolition the week before. The DPP says City Hall never filed an inquiry. Residents in Katani have already protested against a storey building.

DO Do not rent in or work on a building under construction without visible approval notices. Report cracks or building work going up too fast to the county’s building inspectorate.

Fuel prices and protests

EPRA’s fuel price rise brought protests to Nairobi’s CBD and a journalist’s arrest. Matatu operators have raised fares, and activists have announced a march on State House.

DO Check Deckwatch before travelling into the CBD on announced protest days, and plan a route out.

The north and the Ethiopian border

Raiders struck Kibish, Loiyangalani and Marsabit villages in the last week of October, and fighting in Ethiopia sent hundreds of people across the border at Moyale.

DO Travel in Turkana North, Marsabit and Moyale only with current local information. Keep to daylight and to convoys where they run.

From 537 articles to 192 incidents

Deckwatch reads Kenyan news feeds every hour, classifies each article and places it on the map. For this report every article was reviewed by hand. Duplicate reports of the same event were merged into one incident, counties were corrected, and articles that were not about a new incident were set aside.

537
articles captured from Kenyan news feeds

291
described a new safety incident

192
distinct incidents after merging duplicates

147
were context: warnings, court cases, follow-ups

99
were off-topic and excluded

Context set aside: el niño preparedness and weather warnings (34), ebola preparedness and response (7), scheduled power outages (6), court cases and arrests over earlier incidents (42), personal stories and aftermath of earlier events (10), security policy, trends and commentary (48). It informs the watch list but is not counted as incidents.

OUTLETS THIS MONTH · ARTICLES CAPTURED

People Daily	180	Nairobi News	135
Tuko News	129	Citizen Digital	101
K24	69	Kahawa Tungu	66
Nation Africa	66	Capital FM News	61
Kenyans.co.ke	41	The Kenya Times	31
Radio Kaya	23	KBC	19
The Eastleigh Voice	8	Business Today	7
NTV Kenya	5	Ebru TV	4
The Standard	3		

▶ All 192 incidents in this report

IF YOU'RE AFFECTED

Need help now?

999 · 112 · 911
Police emergency (National Police Service)

1199
Kenya Red Cross emergency line

1195
National gender-based violence helpline

116
Childline Kenya

Deckwatch Kenya · October 2026 report · Generated 1 November 2026

Deckwatch reports incidents found in published news. A county with more incidents may simply have more reporters. Always follow instructions from official emergency services.